

KF Reading Guide for HPKP¹

Chapters 5 & 6: *Kinship*

Chapter Five: Kinship, Living as a Family

1. What do all human beings share in common? (157.1)
2. Early Christians lived within what two families? (157.1)

Kinship and Identity

3. A person's family of origin is their primary source for what? (158.2)
 - A.
 - B.
4. According to R. R. Wilson, what does linear genealogy serve to do? (159.2)
5. What do the differences in genealogies show us? (160.2)
6. Which two ancestors of Jesus is Matthew interested in pointing out? (160.2)
7. What is Luke's interest when tracing the genealogy of Jesus? (161.2)
8. Luke's account of Jesus lineage is also a genealogical defense of what title? (162.2)
9. What makes the acceptance of the message of Jesus problematic for His audience? (162.2)

Ascribed Honor and Dishonor

10. What was important for one's own honor? (162.3)
11. If children come from a good, reliable father, what is taken as a given? (163.2)
12. What is an essential part of the inheritance given to children? (163.2)
13. How is the honor of parents and children reciprocal? (163, footnote 11)

The horizontal dimension: The living kinship group

14. What is the sense of *kin* as *kind*? (164.1)
15. What is the widest functional definition of kinship? (164.2)
16. How did Jesus shame the synagogue officials? (165.2)

The Ethos of Kin

17. Consider the differences in how we behave toward kin as opposed to outsiders.
 - A. For which kind of encounters was the ethic of competitiveness reserved? (166.2)
 - B. How do Hellenistic and Greco-Roman ethicists characterize the relationship between siblings? (166.3)
 - C. What was a great evil in classical culture? (167.1)
 - D. What should be the hallmark of interactions between siblings? (167.2)
 - E. What is possible when kin understand themselves to be in cooperation with one another? (168.2)

F. What essential words described kinship ties? (169.2)

G. What advances the mutual interests and honor of family members? (171.3)

H. Finally, what is also stressed by the ancient moralists? (172.2)

18. What was the firm rule of the Pythagoreans? (172.4)

The Household

19. In Aristotle's description of a household, who was the hub of the family unit? (173.3)

20. What was the status of guests and client? (174.1)

Marriage and Divorce

21. What did marrying within the Jewish *ethnos* preserve? (174.3)

22. What was the interest of the Roman marriage practice of exogamy (marrying outside of one's kinship group)? (177.2)

23. What was the purpose of marriage? (177.3)

24. For what was divorce a common recourse? (178.3)

Management of and Behavior Within the Household

25. What does a husband's authority mean? (179.1)

26. What was one important aspect of household life? (179.2)

27. What close correspondence did ancient authors see between household and state? (179.3–180.1)

Husbands and wives

28. What did Aristotle hold to be inherent in the nature of the two genders? (180.2)

29. According to Xenophon, what are the benefits of men and women being complementary and having different aptitudes? (180.footnote 46)

The ethos of the ideal woman

30. What is prominent among the virtues prized in women? (183.2)

31. What is another very prominent facet of the ideal virtue of silence? (183.3)

32. What does this ideal for women very obviously do? (183, footnote 50)

The raising of children

33. In what way are children particularly obligated to their parents? (186.1)

Like parent, like child

34. What does one's behavior reflect? (187.2)

The education of children

35. Who were the three primary educators for young children? (188.2–189)

36. What did the last years of homeschooling include? (189.2)

37. What were ancient ethicists deeply concerned about? (189.3–190.1)

Slavery in the ancient world

38. How did Greco-Roman slavery differ from the Western slavery of the seventeenth through nineteenth centuries? (190.4)

A. Race:

B. Clothing:

C. Becoming a slave:

39. What were the conditions of slavery wholly dependent upon? (191.2)

Fracturing and Remaking Kinship Ties

40. How did Philo measure kinship? (194.1)

41. In extreme cases of disloyalty to the religion and values of the family, how might the unbelieving head of the house respond? (194.2)

42. What threat does association with Jesus pose to natural kinship? (195.3–196.1)

43. How does Jesus redefine His own kin? (197.1)

44. Who becomes the “hundredfold family”? (197.1)

Chapter Six: Kinship & the “Household of God” in the New Testament

1. What is the standard for interpersonal relationships within the church? (199.1)

Creating a New Family

2. What attachment determines whether or not a person is in the family of God? (200.1)

3. What is the purpose of New Testament discussions focused on determining the “true descendants of Abraham” as well as adoption into God’s own family? (200.1)

Jesus’ sonship

4. From what two lines is Jesus descended? (200.2)
5. As “Son”, what does Jesus become? (200.3)

Descent and lineage

6. What heritage would early Christians claim as their own? (201.3)

Redefining Descent from Abraham

7. How do we show our kinship with Abraham? (202.2)
8. How does Jesus strike at the heart of the Jewish doctrines of election? (202.2)
9. Who are those who are ultimately “Israel”? (205.2)

Adoption into the Family of God

10. What stands at the heart of what makes Christians kin to one another? (206.3)
11. In effect, what does “walking in the Spirit” or “led by the Spirit” mean? (207.3)
12. What does our birth into God’s family signal? (207.4)
13. What does the gift of the Holy Spirit do for us as Christians? (211.2)

14. How do God's children counter the power of society's resistance? (211.2)

The Ethos of the "Household of Faith"

15. What family relationship emerges as prominent? (213.2)

Mutual love

16. What is to be the church's essential mark? (213.3)

17. What is the best proof of love for one's parents? (214.1)

Sharing of resources

18. Why are believers to pool their resources in every way? (215.3)

19. What do we witness the early church attempting to create? (215.4)

20. What is also an important expression of the love of believers one for another? (216.2)

Unity, harmony, concord

21. In the Corinthian passage, how is the repetition of "brothers and sisters" strategic? (218.1)

22. What is an erroneous interpretation of the injunction "be of the same mind?" (219.3)

23. What does it mean to be "like minded"? (220.1)

Cooperation and mutual honoring

24. How did many early Christians approach life in the church and discipleship? (220.2)

25. How are Christians supposed to view one another? (220.2)

26. What are Christians NOT to create? (221.2)

“Natural” Households and Early Christianity

27. How was early Christianity a “household” movement? (226.4)

28. Second, in what other ways was early Christianity a household movement? (227.2)

Managing the Christian (natural) household

29. What offers Christians the best possible security for their existence as a group? (228.3)

Marriage and Remarriage

30. What did the Christian stance on keeping marriage inviolate achieve? (229.3)

A.

B.

Household Codes

31. What does Paul attempt to maintain among Corinthian believers? (230.4)

32. What distinctively Christian addition do New Testament authors bring to the relationship between husband and wife? (231.3–232.1)

33. What is the essential and paradoxical nature of authority personified in Christ? (232.1)

34. In what way does Christ transform marriage? (232, footnote 27)

35. What is the great dignity conferred on the woman by God? (233.1)
36. What is presented as a check to the inherent *hybris* (pride and sense of entitlement) of the masters? (235.1)
37. What would have happened if Christians had announced a full frontal assault on the institution of slavery? (235.2–236)
- A.
- B.

Conclusion

38. What can the church no longer afford to be? (239.3)
39. What must the church become? (239.3)

¹ This reading guide refers to the 2000 edition of *Honor, Patronage, Kinship & Purity* by David A. deSilva, published by Inter Varsity Press, Downers Grove, IL.